

Atlas

The Titan holding up the world, and a book of maps

Zone-based fog of war for any game system. Trace the rooms of a map, wire them together, and tokens hide and reveal themselves per player as they move. No wall drawing, no light sources, no per-token vision maths: a room either sees another room or it does not, and you decide which.

Covers Atlas 1.0. Screenshots taken from a live Foundry v14 session.
Atlas is system agnostic. Nothing in it depends on the game system you run.

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1 The idea in one page

Three things, and everything else follows from them.

A room is a shape you draw

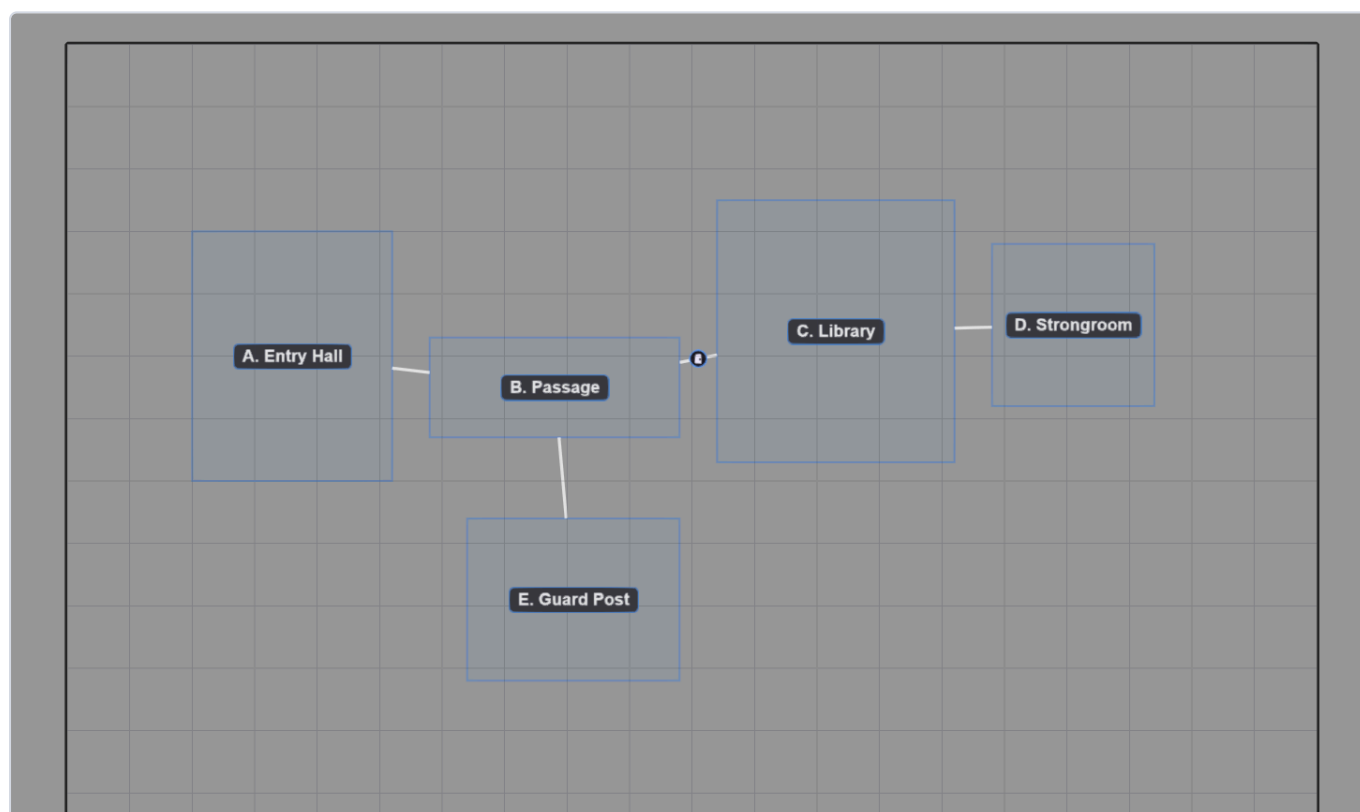
You trace a polygon over part of your battlemat and it becomes a room. It gets a letter automatically, and you can give it a name. The letter is how the module refers to it; the name is what your players read.

A connection is a way through

Two rooms are connected or they are not. A connection is a *door*, not adjacency: two rooms can share a long wall and still have no connection between them, because there is no way through that wall. Connections are what sight travels along, and, if you want, what movement is limited to.

Sight follows the connections

Every room has three switches. **In**: can this room be seen into from outside? **Out**: can someone standing in it see elsewhere? **Through**: can sight cross this room on its way somewhere further off? For one token to see another, the viewer's room must allow Out, the target's room must allow In, and every room the route passes through must allow Through.



A finished map. Five rooms, each with a name, joined by four connections drawn as white lines across the gaps between them. The small disc on the line between B and C is a doorway. This is the Keeper's view; players see the room outlines but not the connection lines.

2 Your first map

Open the room panel on the scene you want to work on. If your game system does not put a button somewhere for you, a one-line macro does it:

```
ATLAS.openRoomPanel()
```

On a scene with no rooms yet, the panel opens ready to draw. There is nothing else it can usefully offer, so it shows you only the three controls that do not need a room to exist.



An empty map. Square and Line are the two drawing tools. Traffic is a rule about the whole world, so it is here too.

Draw, name, connect, seal

1. **Square** and drag a rectangle, or **Line** and click the corners (Enter or right-click finishes). Either way you are asked for a name. Leave it blank if you do not want one yet.
2. The panel lands on the new room. Type the room's name into the field at the top.
3. Press **Connect** and click your way around the map, joining each room to its neighbours.
4. As you connect, turn **Through** off on the rooms that are walls between places. See section 6, and read the warning there before you build anything large.
5. Put **doorways** on the connections that are real doors, and **blackout** on anything the party should not know exists.
6. Turn **Traffic** red last, once the map is fully wired.

NAME AS YOU GO

A room you have not named draws no label on the map at all. That is deliberate: a battlemat cut into a dozen areas should not be carpeted in letters nobody reads. But it does mean that if you draw twelve rooms and name none of them, you will be looking at twelve identical blue boxes. The letters are still in the data, and the Areas editor lists them, so nothing is lost.

ROOMS MUST NOT OVERLAP

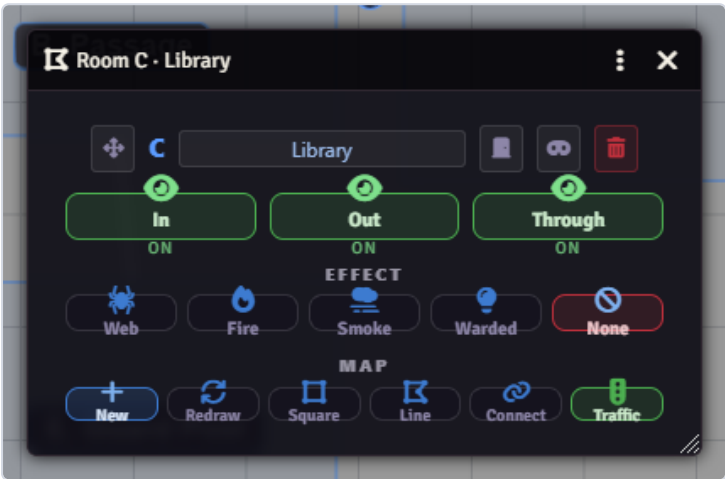
A point belongs to the first room whose outline contains it, so a room drawn *inside* another can never be clicked, opened, or connected from the map. If you want a vault inside a hall, draw it beside the hall and connect the two.

LEAVE A LITTLE SPACE BETWEEN ROOMS

A connection line is drawn across the gap between two rooms, clipped to each outline. Two rooms that touch exactly produce a line with nowhere to go, so you will not see it. Everything still works, but the map is easier to read with a small gap.

3 The room panel

One window that follows whichever room you are working on. It never opens a second copy of itself and it always shows the live state of the room: if something changes the room from elsewhere, the panel changes with it.



The whole tool. Three rows: the room itself, its sight, its dressing, and then everything to do with the map.

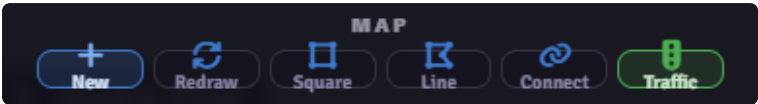
Getting it to the room you want

GESTURE	WHAT HAPPENS
Double-click a room	Opens the panel on that room. Anywhere inside it works, not just the label.
Double-click a token	That token's sheet opens and the panel stays where it is. The creature always wins.
Single-click a room	If the panel is already open, it re-points at that room. It never opens a panel that was closed.

The top row: this room

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Move	Switches move mode on for the whole map. Section 10.
Letter	The room's identity. Not editable: it is assigned when the room is traced, and freed when it is deleted.
Name field	What your players see. Type and press Enter, or click away. Clearing it removes the label from the map entirely.
Doorway	Puts a sight block on one of this room's connections. Section 7.
Hide	Blackout: takes this room off the players' map and refuses entry. Section 8.
Delete	Removes the room, its outline, its label, and every connection to it. It asks first.

The Map row



Six controls: where the next shape goes, how you draw it, joining rooms, and the movement rule.

The colour language

LOOK	MEANING
grey	Idle. Pressing it starts something.
blue	This is the resting choice of a pair, or this is laid on this room.
amber	Armed. Your next click on the map means something different from usual.
red	Destructive, or, on the traffic light, enforcing.
green	A sight switch that is on, or traffic running free.

ONE QUESTION AT A TIME

Move mode, an armed doorway and connect mode all want your next click on the map. Only one of them can be live, and starting any of them stops the other two. **Escape** cancels whichever is running.

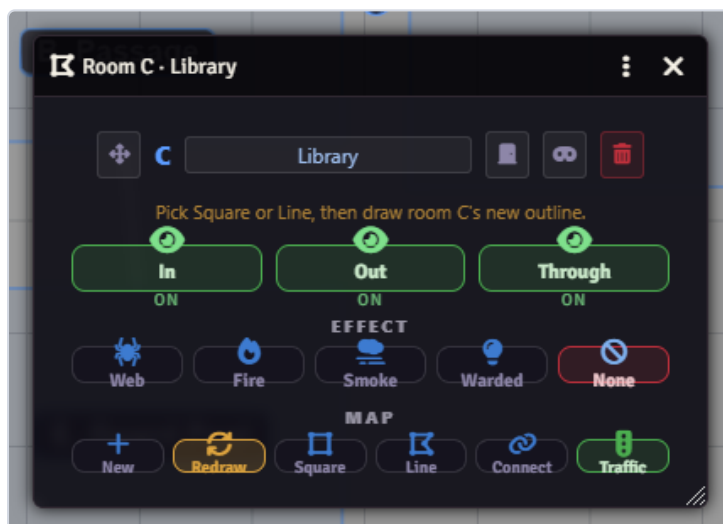
4 Drawing rooms

Four buttons that work as two pairs: *where* the next shape goes, and *how* you draw it.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
New	The next shape becomes a brand new room. This is where the pair rests, so you can ignore it entirely and just press Square or Line.
Redraw	Arms. The next shape replaces this room's outline , keeping everything else about it.
Square	Click and drag a rectangle. The fast one.
Line	Click the corners. Enter or right-click finishes, Backspace undoes a corner, Escape cancels.

Redrawing a room you traced badly

Press **Redraw**, then Square or Line, then draw the new shape. The room's name, its three sight switches, its effects, its blackout, every connection to it and every doorway on those connections all carry over. Only the outline changes.



Redraw armed. The button is amber and a line of text tells you what your next action will do. New has gone out, because it is no longer the target.

THE ARM IS SPENT WHEN THE TOOL STARTS

Pressing Square or Line consumes the Redraw arm immediately and remembers which room it named. That means the shape you eventually draw lands on the room you meant, even if you spend a while tracing. It also means that if you cancel the drawing with Escape, you press Redraw again.

5 Connecting rooms

Press **Connect** once and it stays on. Click a room, click another, and they are joined. Then it resets and waits for the next pair, so a whole map goes in without coming back to the button.

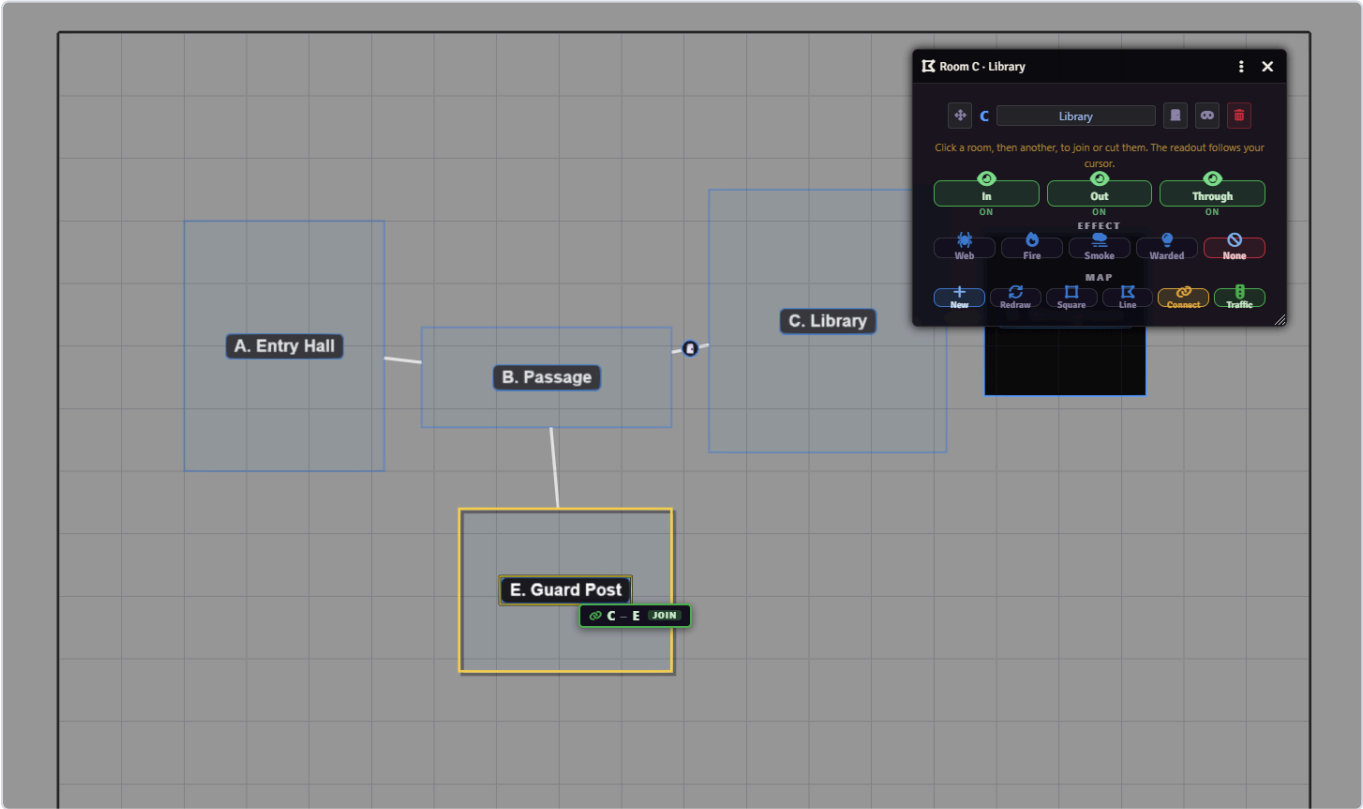
The readout is the state

A small panel follows your cursor while connect mode is live. It has two slots and a dash. The **left** slot is the room you have picked. The **right** slot is the room under your cursor right now. A question mark means that slot is empty.

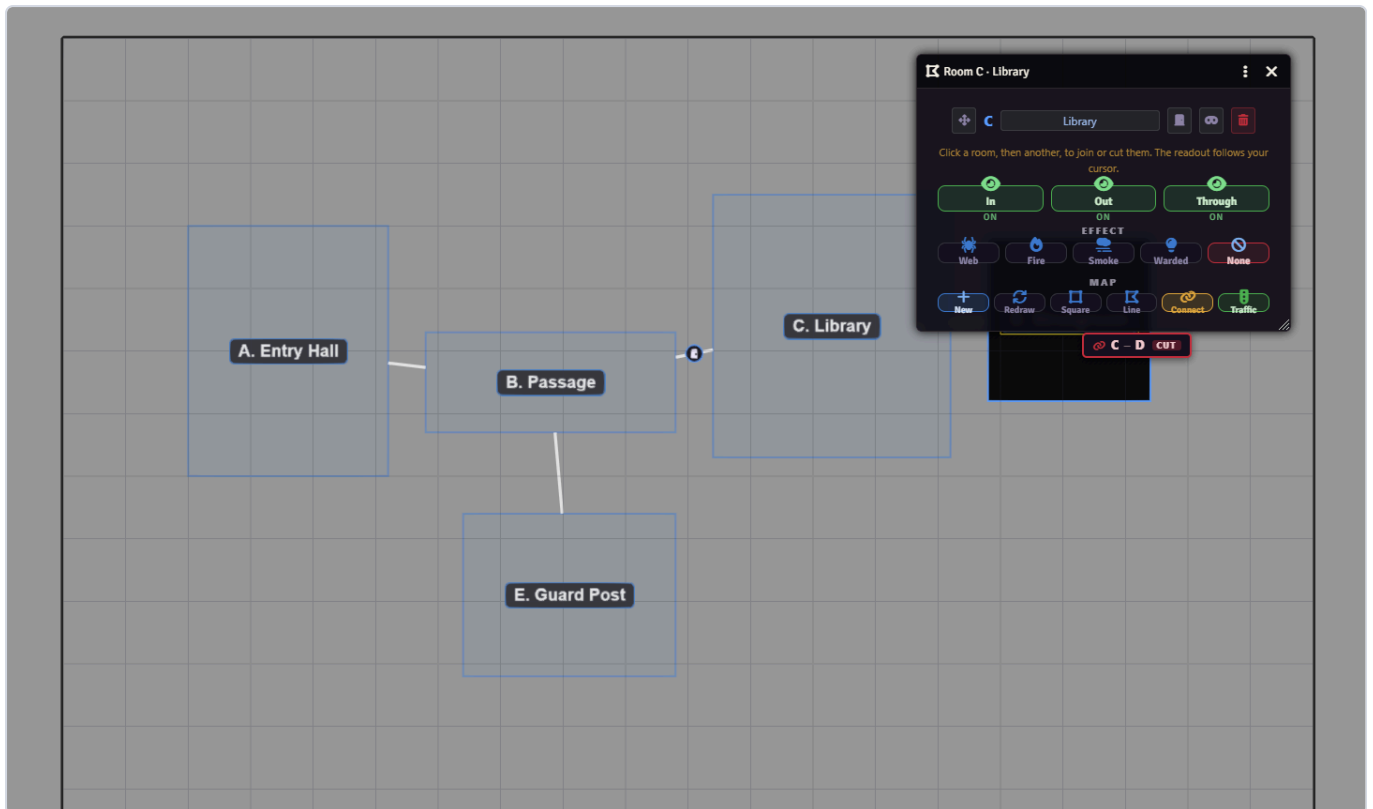
READS	MEANS
? – ?	Nothing picked, cursor on no room. Your next click picks a room.
A – ?	A is picked. Move onto another room to see what clicking would do.
A – B join	Clicking now joins A and B.
A – B cut	A and B are already joined. Clicking now cuts them.

RIGHT-CLICK CLEARS BOTH SLOTS

Turning Connect on picks the room the panel is showing as the first end, which saves a click when that is the room you want and is in the way when it is not. **Right-click** puts the readout back to ? – ? and you carry on from whichever room you like, without switching the mode off and on again. A right *drag* still pans the map, so wiring something larger than the screen is unaffected.



About to join. The room panel is on C, the cursor is over E, and the readout says **C – E JOIN** in green. The room under the cursor is lifted and outlined so there is no doubt which one you are aiming at.



About to cut. Same mode, cursor over D, which C is already joined to. The readout turns red and says **CUT**. Connect is one gesture that does opposite things, so it always tells you which one before you commit.

CUTTING TAKES THE DOORWAY WITH IT

If the connection you cut had a doorway on it, the doorway goes too. A sight block belongs to a connection and cannot outlive one. Rejoining the two rooms afterwards gives you a plain, open connection, not the old doorway back.

To stop, press **Connect** again or hit **Escape**. Clicking the room you have already picked lets it go without joining anything, and a right-click clears both slots.

6 Sight: In, Out and Through

For a token in room V to see a token in room T , all of the following must hold:

- V allows **Out**.
- T allows **In**.
- There is a route from V to T along the connections.
- Every room on that route between them allows **Through**.
- No step of that route crosses a doorway.

Anyone in your own room is always visible, whatever the switches say.

READ THIS BEFORE YOU BUILD A LARGE MAP

Every new room starts with all three switches **on**, and sight has **no distance limit**: it walks the connections until something stops it. So the moment you wire a dungeon into one connected graph, every room can see every other room and the fog appears to do nothing.

This is not a fault. It is waiting for you to turn **Through** off on the rooms that are walls between places: corridors, doorways, stairwells, anything that should not let sight run straight past it. Do it as you connect, not at the end.

Which switch do I want?

YOU WANT	SET
A corridor that joins two halls without letting them see each other	Corridor: Through off
A dark alcove nobody can see into, but you can see out of	Alcove: In off
A smoke-filled room whose occupants are blind	Room: Out off
A long gallery you <i>can</i> see down	Leave all three on

7 Doorways

A doorway is a sight block on *one* connection. The three room switches are blunt: they apply to every route through a room. A doorway is precise.

It works **exactly like Connect**: press it once and it stays live, click a room and click another, and a doorway goes on the connection between them. Then it resets and waits for the next pair, so a run of doors goes in without coming back to the button.

With one in place, sight cannot cross that connection in either direction. Other connections into the same rooms carry on working normally.

A DOORWAY NEVER STOPS ANYONE WALKING

It is a sight rule, not a barrier. The two rooms stay connected, travel distance is unchanged, and tokens move across it freely. Moving a token across a doorway does not open it, and players never interact with one. It is your setting, and only you change it.

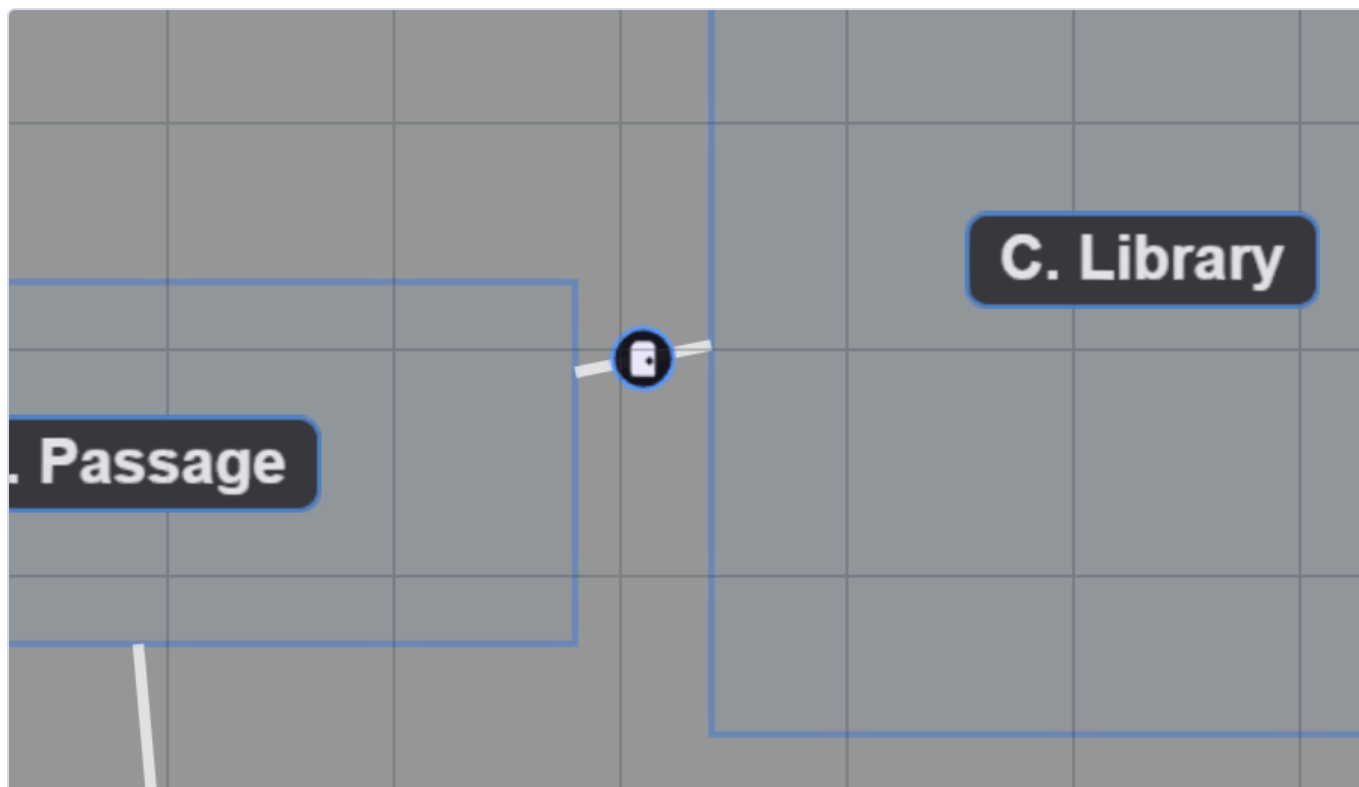
Putting one in

- 1. Press the **doorway** button on the top row. It turns amber, and the room the panel is on is picked as the first end.
- 2. Click the room on the other side. Right-click first if you would rather start somewhere else.
- 3. Carry on clicking pairs. Press the button again, or Escape, when you are done.

READOUT READS	MEANS
A – B door	Clicking now puts a doorway on that connection.
A – B open	There is already one. Clicking now takes it off , which can reveal actors to everyone with a sight route.
A – B no link	Those two rooms are not connected, so there is nothing to put a doorway on. Connect them first.



Armed. As with everything on this panel, arming says so in words as well as colour.



On the map. A doorway rides the middle of its own connection line. Players can see it.

IT TELLS YOU BEFORE YOU CLICK, NOT AFTER

The two rooms must already be connected, and the readout says **no link** in amber when they are not. If you click anyway you get a warning and *keep your first pick*, so the next click can be the room you actually meant. Atlas will not quietly create the connection for you: that would make the two rooms walkable, which is the one thing a doorway must never do.

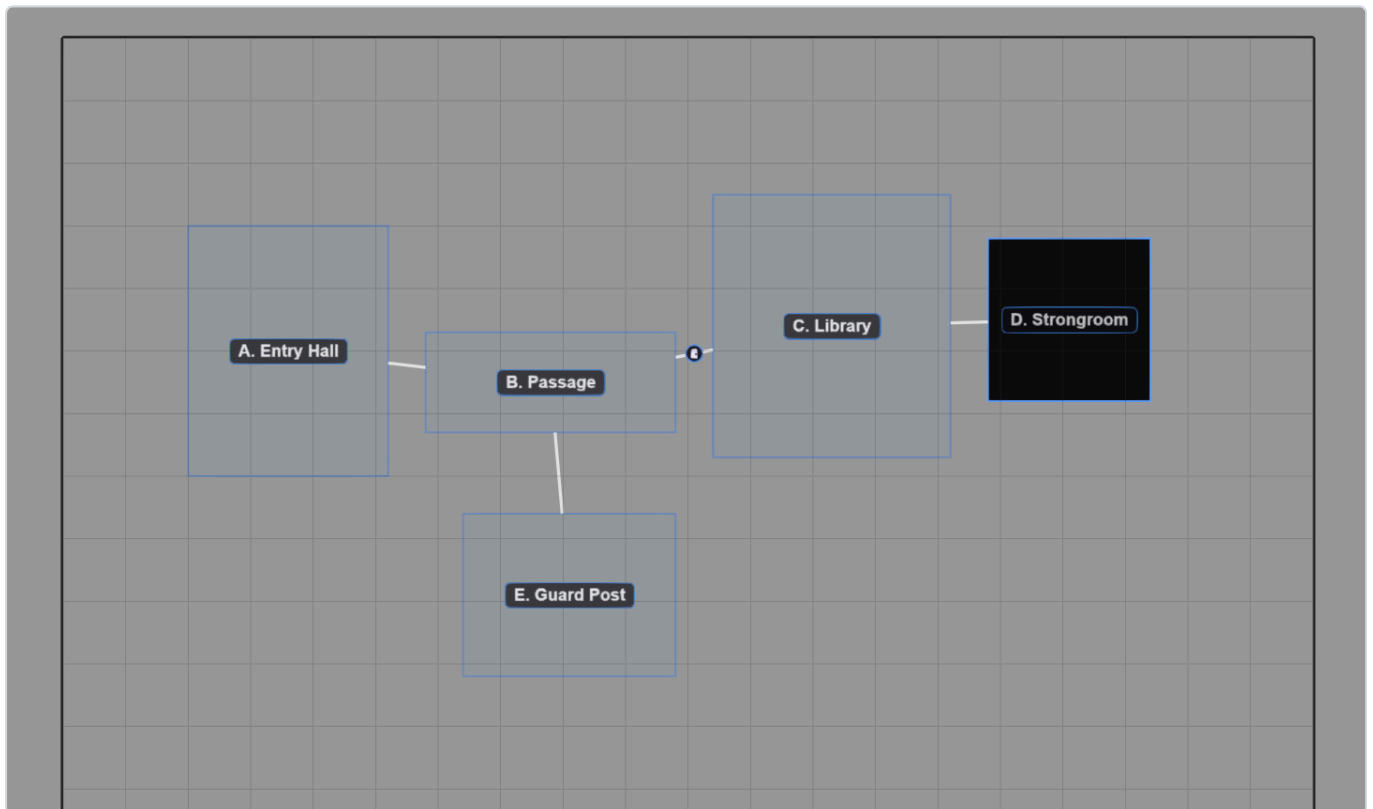
8 Blackout: hiding a room

For the secret room, the sealed vault, the part of the map that does not exist yet as far as the party is concerned.

A blacked-out room, for your players:

- has no outline and no label on the map;
- has no connection lines running to it, and no door icons on them;
- shows nothing that is standing in it;
- cannot be entered. A token moved into it is refused with "You cannot go that way", which does not name the room.

For you it stays visible, drawn in black with a blue edge so you can tell at a glance which rooms are hidden.



The Keeper's view. D, the Strongroom, is blacked out. Your players see bare map there.



The switch. The mask button on the room's own row. Press it again to reveal the room.

BLACKOUT REFUSES ENTRY REGARDLESS OF TRAFFIC

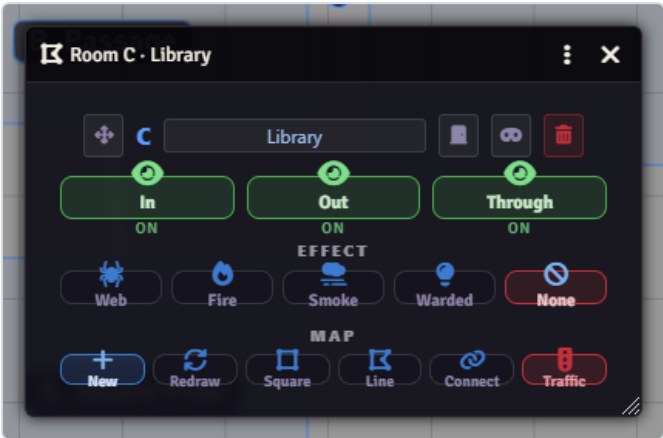
The movement rule in section 9 is optional. Blackout is not: a hidden room is sealed whether or not Traffic is on, because a room your players cannot see is not a room they can walk into. Reveal it a beat before the party arrives.

THE LINES GO WITH THE ROOM

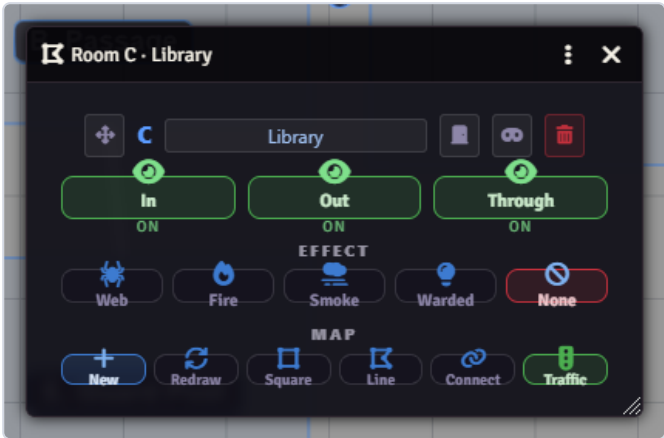
Every white connection line touching a hidden room is taken away from the table too, along with any door icon riding one. Lines converging on an empty patch of map say "something is here" about as loudly as an outline would. Reveal the room and they all come back. You see the lot throughout.

9 Traffic: holding players to the map

Off by default. With it on, a player may only move a token between rooms that are connected.



Red: held. Connections are enforced.



Green: free. Tokens go anywhere; connections only steer sight.

It is the one control on the panel that is never grey, because a light that is off tells you nothing. It is also a **world** setting rather than a property of a scene or a room, so it is the same switch as the one in Foundry's module settings, and changing it in either place moves the other.

The rules it applies

CASE	RESULT
One hop	A move is legal when it starts and ends in the same room, or in two rooms that are directly connected. A to C is refused even if the drag sweeps across B; reaching C takes two moves.
You are exempt	The Keeper is never restricted, and is never warned about it either.
Outside every room	A token standing in no room at all may move anywhere. This is the honest answer on a map traced by hand.
No connections yet	A map with rooms but no connections is left alone entirely, rather than freezing every token on it.
Undo and paste	Never restricted.

TURN IT RED LAST

Wire the whole map first. A half-connected map with Traffic on refuses perfectly reasonable moves and your players will report it as a bug.

10 Moving rooms and labels

Move mode

Press the four-arrow button at the top left of the panel. While it is lit, dragging anywhere inside *any* room picks that room up; let go to put it down. The room's outline and every connection line touching it follow.

IT TAKES OVER THE DRAG

While move mode is on you cannot pan the map by dragging inside a room, and you cannot drag a token that is standing in one. That is what a mode is, and it is why the button stays lit the whole time. Escape, or the button, turns it off. It also unlocks the map while it runs and puts your lock back afterwards.

Labels move on their own

A label is a name plate, not a pin the room hangs from. Dragging a label moves only the label; moving a room leaves its label where you put it. A label lying inside its own room still takes the drag, so you can nudge it without shoving the room out from under it first.

REDRAW, IN THE AREAS EDITOR, DOES NOT MOVE ROOMS

In older versions the editor's Redraw button dragged every room to its label's position. It no longer does anything of the sort: it repaints outlines and connection lines from the saved shapes, which is a repair for a drawing that has been deleted or has drifted. Use move mode to move a room.

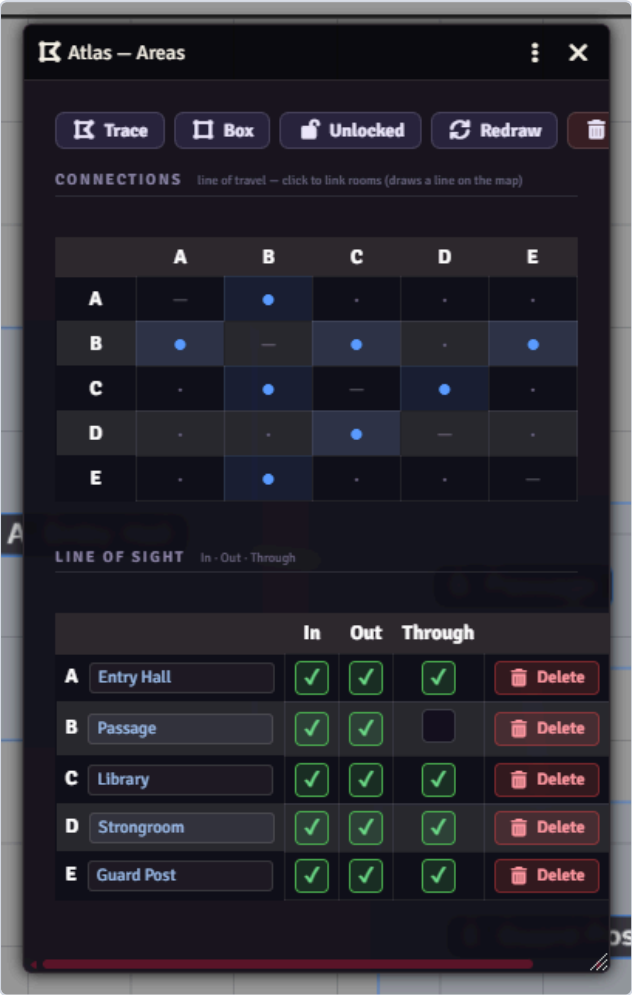
11 Effects

Web, Fire, Smoke and Ward are dressing you can lay on a room. They stack, so a room can carry more than one, and each tints the room's outline. The **None** chip clears the lot.

Some effects also seal the room's sight switches while they hold, which is noted in each one's tooltip. What an effect *means* mechanically is your game system's business, not the module's: Atlas marks the room and tells the system it is marked.

12 The Areas editor

The map's index. Where the room panel is for working on one room, this shows the whole scene at once, and it is the fastest way to check your work.



Connections and sight, as tables. A blue dot is a connection; click a cell to add or remove one. Below, every room's three sight switches in one place. Here B's Through is off, so the Passage joins the Entry Hall to the Library without letting them see each other.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Trace / Box	The same two drawing tools as Line and Square on the panel.
Locked	Locks the room outlines and labels so you do not nudge them while moving combatants.
Redraw	Repaints every outline and line from the saved shapes. A repair, not a move.
Clear	Wipes every room on the scene. It asks first.

THE MATRIX IS THE FASTEST AUDIT

Come back to a map a week later and the connection matrix tells you in one glance what is joined to what. It is worth opening before a session just to confirm the map is wired the way you remember.

13 Every gesture, in one table

DO THIS	GET THIS
Double-click inside a room	Opens the room panel on it.
Double-click a token	The token's sheet. The panel does not move.
Click inside a room	Re-points an open panel at it.
Drag a label	Moves the label only.
Drag inside a room, move mode on	Moves the room only.
Right-click, in Connect or Doorway	Clears both slots of the readout. A right drag still pans.
Escape	Cancels an armed doorway, connect mode, a pending redraw, or move mode.
Enter or right-click, while drawing with Line	Finishes the shape.
Backspace, while drawing with Line	Removes the last corner.
Escape, while drawing	Cancels the shape.
Hover a room with a token selected	A readout on that room's label: hops away, and whether you can see it.

For macros and other modules

CALL	DOES
<code>ATLAS.openRoomPanel()</code>	Opens the panel, optionally on a given letter.
<code>ATLAS.openEditor()</code>	Opens the Areas editor.
<code>ATLAS.hasAreas(scene)</code>	Does this scene have any rooms traced?
<code>ATLAS.roomAt(x, y)</code>	Which room is this point strictly inside, or null.
<code>ATLAS.roomDistance(a, b)</code>	Hops between two rooms over the connections.
<code>ATLAS.hasLOS(scene, a, b)</code>	Can room A see room B?
<code>ATLAS.setAreaEffect(label, id)</code>	Lay an effect on a room.

14 When something looks wrong

Everyone can see everyone

Your rooms are all connected and every room still has **Through** on. Sight has no distance limit, so it walks the whole map. Turn Through off on the corridors and walls. This is by far the most common surprise; see the warning in section 6.

A player got refused a move that looked fine

Either Traffic is red and those two rooms are not connected, or the destination is blacked out. Check the connection matrix in the Areas editor first.

I cannot click a room

It is probably drawn inside another room. Only the first room containing a point is found, so a nested room is unreachable from the map. Move it, or redraw it beside its neighbour and connect the two.

The map did not update

Press **Redraw** in the Areas editor. It rebuilds every outline and connection line from the stored data, which fixes a drawing that was deleted by accident or has drifted.

I armed something and now clicking does nothing useful

Press **Escape**. It cancels every armed state the panel has. The panel also always says in words what an armed control is waiting for, so if there is no line of amber text, nothing is armed.

A room I deleted left something behind

It should not: deleting a room takes its outline, its label, every connection to it and every doorway on those connections. If a stray drawing remains, Redraw in the Areas editor clears it.

ROOMS ARE PER SCENE

Everything here lives on the scene you traced it on. Switching scenes gives you that scene's rooms, and the panel follows. Nothing carries over between scenes.